

Areli Mercado

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley (College of CDSS)

Berkeley, CA

Intended Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science

08/2025 – Expected May 2029

- **Relevant Coursework:** Foundations of Data Science, Structure and Interpretation of Computer Programs, Data Structures and Algorithms, SMC C Programming, Discrete Mathematics and Probability Theory, Linear Algebra and Differential Equations, Intro to Neurotechnology
- **Student Organizations:** CS Kickstart and CS Scholars, Hispanic Engineers and Scientists, Cal Actuary League

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, Java, C, HTML/CSS

Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (fluent)

PROJECTS

Personal Portfolio Website (HTML, CSS)

07/2026 – Present

- Designed and developed a responsive personal portfolio website using HTML and CSS to showcase projects, experience, and interests.
- Implemented custom styling, responsive layouts, smooth navigation, and interactive hover effects for desktop and mobile.

Build Your Own World Engine (Java)

04/2026

- Developed a tile-based world generation and exploration system using Java, incorporating data structures and graph traversal.
- Implemented file I/O to save and load game progress across sessions.

WordNet / NGordnet (Java)

03/2026

- Built a Java application to model and query relationships between words using graph-based data structures.
- Implemented graph traversal and utilized HashMaps and Sets to efficiently process and retrieve connected word data.

Scheme Interpreter (Python)

11/2025

- Built an interpreter for the Scheme programming language in Python, implementing expression evaluation and core language functionality.
- Applied recursion and object-oriented programming to parse and evaluate Scheme expressions.

EXPERIENCE

Hello World Mentor

Berkeley, CA

08/2026 – Present

- Mentor students as they develop foundational programming skills, providing guidance during coding activities and helping create a supportive environment for learning and problem-solving.

CS Kickstart

Berkeley, CA

08/2025 – 08/2026

- Participated in UC Berkeley's CS Kickstart program and served as a volunteer teaching assistant for the Preparatory Track.
- Taught introductory CS 61A material in Python, including expressions, conditionals, iteration, functions, and environment diagrams.